Discussion panel: Data are plural, so are data stewards!

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Social Science Data Archives, University of Ljubljana, Slovenia
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Pedro Príncipe
University of Minho Documentation and Libraries Services, Portugal
***Moderated by Robin Rice**, University of Edinburgh, United Kingdom*

IASSIST 2025, Bristol, 4-6 June 2025

Discussion panel: Data are plural, so are data stewards!

The Slovenian Case

IASSIST 2025, 4 – 6 June 2025

Sonja Bezjak and Irena Vipavc Brvar

Slovenian Social Science Data Archives

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Financira Evropska unija NextGenerationEU

NOO NAČRT ZA OKREVANJE IN ODPORNOST

REPUBLIKA SLOVENIJA MINISTRSTVO ZA VISOKO ŠOLSTVO ZNANOST IN INOVACIJE

ADP Arhiv družboslovnih podatkov

SPOZNAJ PODPORA PRI UVAJANJU NAČEL ODPRTE ZNANOSTI V SLOVENIJI

Slovenian Social Science Data Archives

Arhiv družboslovnih podatkov (ADP)

- 📅 **Established:** 1997
- 📌 **Role:** National center for social sciences
- 🔒 **Trust:** Core Trust Seal certificate (since 2018)
- 🌐 **Membership:** CESSDA ERIC
- 🤝 **Collaboration:** National and international projects
- 🔗 **Website:** www.adp.fdv.uni-lj.si

Open Science policies by national government

Reform of the **national legislation** on scientific research and innovation according to the **European Research Area** (ERA) reform

- Scientific Research and Innovation Activity Act, Art. 40-42. (adopted in 2021)
- Action plan for Open Science for the implementation of Objective 6.2: Open Science to improve the research quality, efficiency, and responsiveness of the Resolution on the Slovenian Scientific Research and Innovation Strategy 2030 (ReZrIS30).
- Decree on the implementation of scientific research work in accordance with the principles of open science. (adopted in 2023)

- **The government has allocated €16 million for the implementation of the Strategy between 2023-2030.**

Fostering implementation of Open Science in Slovenia

The SPOZNAJ project

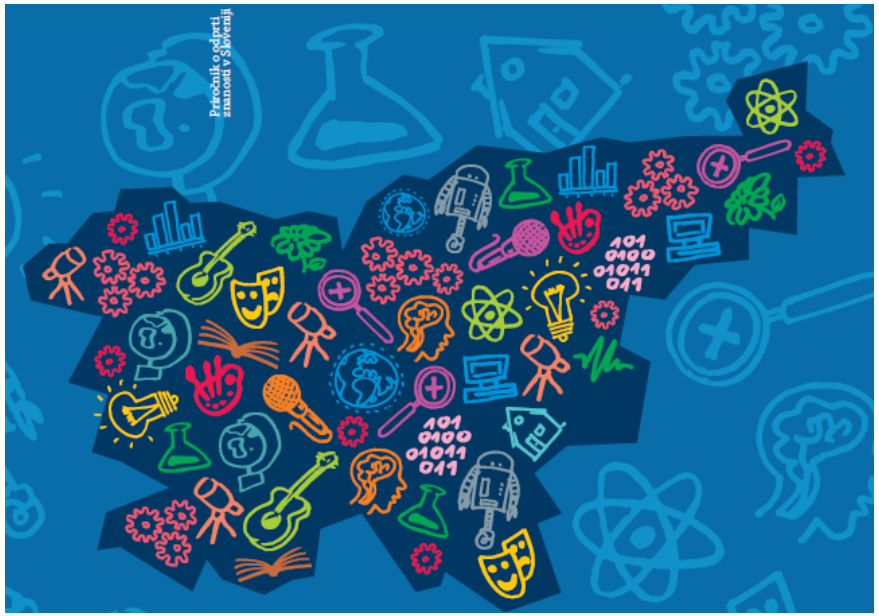
Project duration:

1 May 2023 - 30 June 2026

Total funding:

EUR 4.031.728,66

- NOO: EUR 3 999 994,81
- VAT: EUR 31 733,85



Consortium partners:

- **20 Slovenian public research organisations and The Central Technical Library of the University of Ljubljana**

- *The SPOZNAJ project is co-funded by the Republic of Slovenia, the Ministry of Higher Education, Science and Innovation, and the European Union – NextGenerationEU through the national Recovery and Resilience Plan.*

REPUBLIKA SLOVENIJA
MINISTRSTVO ZA VISOKO ŠOLSTVO, ZNANOST IN INOVACIJE

NAČRT ZA OKREVANJE IN ODPORNOST

Financira Evropska unija
NextGenerationEU

Purpose of the project

- accelerate the **adoption of open science practices among project partners**,
- make a substantial contribution to the **digital transformation of scientific research**,
- **share OS knowledge and experiences and disseminate** them to public infrastructure institutes (IZUM, ARNES), public agencies (ARIS, NAKVIS), privately owned higher education and research institutes, researchers and experts from the commercial sector, private researchers, and the broader interested public.

Expected result: A substantial share of **research publications** will be **available in Slovenian repositories**, with **greater public access to research data** also expected.

https://projekt-spoznaj.si/en/predstavitev-projekta/

Work packages

SPOZNAJ
PODPORA PRI UVAJANJU NAČEL ODPRTE ZNANOSTI V SLOVENIJI

- **Conducting trainings on open science practices and on sharing research according to FAIR principles**
- **Preparation and implementation of dedicated trainings for operation according to the principles of open science**

  Defining profiles of support professionals and creating a catalogue of competencies
  Creation of the data steward training program and creation of manuals
  Implementation of the data steward training
  Establishment of a group of supporting experts/coordinators to support the project partners' staff and other interested parties in training and implementation of open science.
- **Comprehensive adaptation of open science operations and evaluation of results of consortium partners**

  Analysis of business/organizational models of support structures to open science from the perspective of the needs of individual consortium partners and preparation of recommendations
  Open science adaptation plan and pilot introduction of major adjustments
  Preparation of internal organizational and other regulations, documents, policies
  Implementation of adjustments

Source

Some of the results so far

WP4: Preparation and implementation of trainings …

- **Catalogue of competences** for data experts
- **Programme** of specialised training for data experts **created,** lecturers **recruited**
- A three week **training for data stewards** conducted between September and November 2024
    - **A 72 hour training:** 4 blocks of 4 days - 6 hours a day
    - **Limited to 30 participants** attending in person and **around 90 participants** online.

More information about the training:

https://projekt-spoznaj.si/en/projekt-spoznaj-jeseni-pricenja-z-usposabljanjem-za-podatkovne-strokovnjake/

SPOZNAJ
PODPORA PRI UVAJANJU NAČEL ODPRTE ZNANOSTI V SLOVENIJI

+ online

Priročnik o načrtovanju ravnanja z raziskovalnimi podatki

Handbook on open science

1. The development of the concept of open science and its fundamental principles
2. Provisions on open science in Slovenia
3. The life cycle of research in open science
4. Documenting research results
5. Compliance of research results with the FAIR principles
6. National open science infrastructure
7. Open licences
8. Research results in open science
9. Open peer review
10. Citizen science

Authors:

- dr. Sonja Bezjak (Social Science Data Archives)
- Peter Čerče (Science and Research Centre Koper)
- Ana Fidler (Central Technical Library)
- dr. Mojca Kotar (University of Ljubljana)
- mag. Dunja Legat (University Library Maribor)
- dr. Brane Leskošek (University of Ljubljana, ELIXIR-SI)
- mag. Miro Pušnik (Central Technical Library)
- mag. Irena Vipavc Brvar (Social Science Data Archives)
- dr. Anže Županič (National Institute of Biology)

More

Open science terminology dictionary

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PODPORA PRI UVAJANJU NAČEL ODPRTE ZNANOSTI V SLOVENIJI

« Nazaj na zadetke

Slovar
Terminološki slovar odprte znanosti

Avtorji
Mateja Jemec Tomazin, Sonja Bezjak, Irena Vipavc Brvar

Področje
Bibliotekarstvo in informacijska znanost

Vir
Slovenski terminološki portal

O terminu

TERMIN: podatkovni svetovalec/podatkovna svetovalka

DEFINICIJA: **oseba, ki svetuje pri ravnanju s podatki in drugimi digitalnimi objekti v skladu z načeli FAIR ter je na ravni raziskovalne organizacije načeloma odgovorna za organizacijo ravnanja s podatki, npr. svetuje vodstvu pri usmeritvah glede ravnanja s podatki, spremlja zakonodajo, priporočila, usmeritve**

ANGLEŠČINA

TERMIN: data steward

Komentarji

REPUBLIKA SLOVENIJA
MINISTRSTVO ZA KULTURO

Naložbo sofinancirata Republika Slovenija in Evropska unija iz Evropskega sklada za regionalni razvoj
https://www.eu-skladi.si

EVROPSKA UNIJA
EVROPSKI SKLAD ZA REGIONALNI RAZVOJ

Dictionary

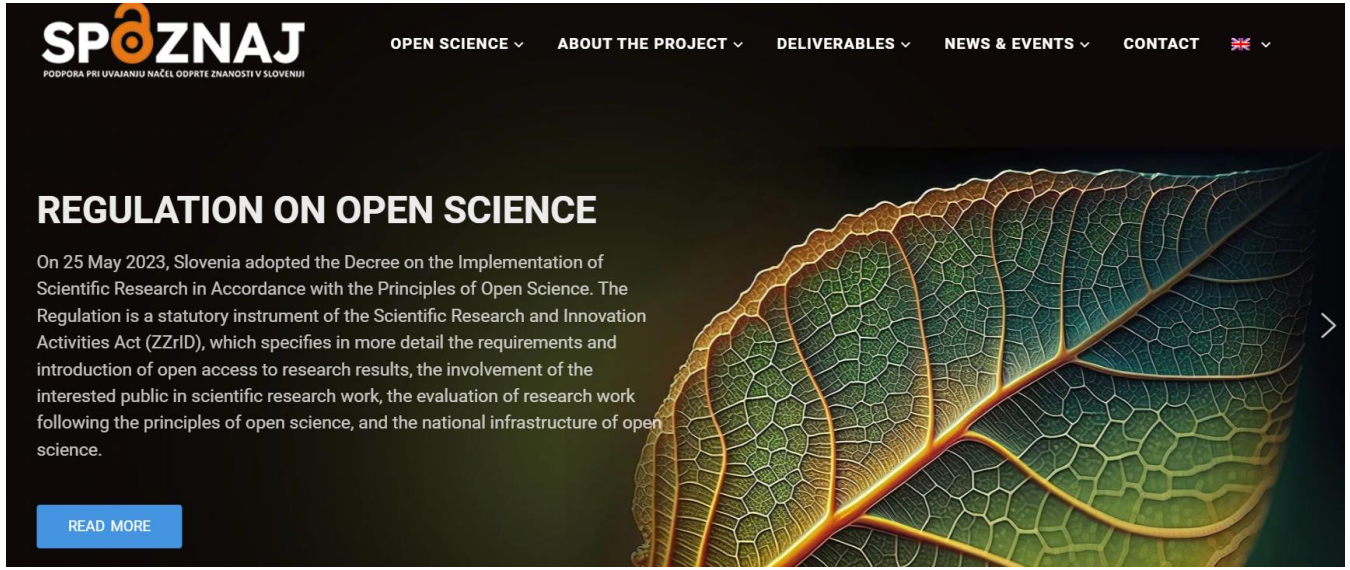
More information about the project

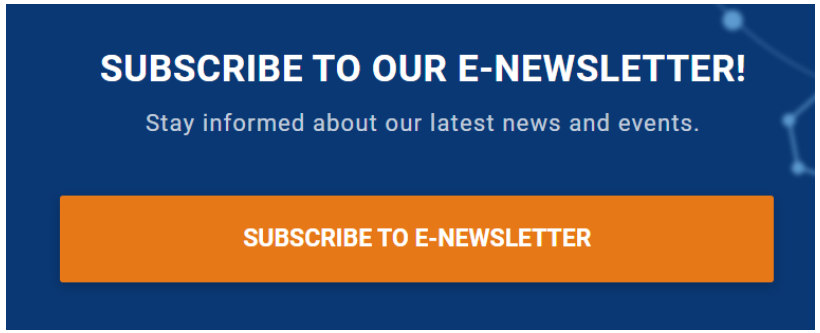
Project website:
https://projekt-spoznaj.si

Newsletter subscription (in English):
http://eepurl.com/iuwA5c

Video archive:
https://video.arnes.si/en/?channel=9lcqz6j71lg7

E-mail:
noo.spoznaj@ctk.uni-lj.si





SPOZNAJ

PODPORA PRI UVAJANJU NAČEL ODPRTE ZNANOSTI V SLOVENIJI

Centralna tehniška knjižnica Univerze v Ljubljani
Central Technical Library at the University of Ljubljana
Trg republike 3, SI-1000 Ljubljana
Slovenija / *Slovenia*

Thank you!

Sonja.Bezjak@fdv.uni-lj.si
Irena.Vipavc@fdv.uni-lj.si

Re.Data

Data are plural, so are data stewards!

visions, actions and plans from Portugal

Bristol, 5 June 2025 | Pedro Principe, University of Minho

Universidade do Minho · Universidade de Coimbra · iscte Instituto Universitário de Lisboa · ipb Bragança Polytechnic University / Instituto Politécnico de Bragança · NOVA Universidade Nova de Lisboa · FCCN · fct Fundação para a Ciência e a Tecnologia · PRR Plano de Recuperação e Resiliência · República Portuguesa · Financiado pela União Europeia NextGenerationEU

Re.Data

Rede para a Gestão de Dados de Investigação

National Project and consortium to support RDM in Portugal.
Network to support the upskilling national agenda and the infrastructures and services implementation

Portuguese RDM FORUM
Community driver initiative started in 2016. Annual event + 3 Working Groups on Policies, Training and Repositories.
Over 400 people participated, over 100 active WG members.

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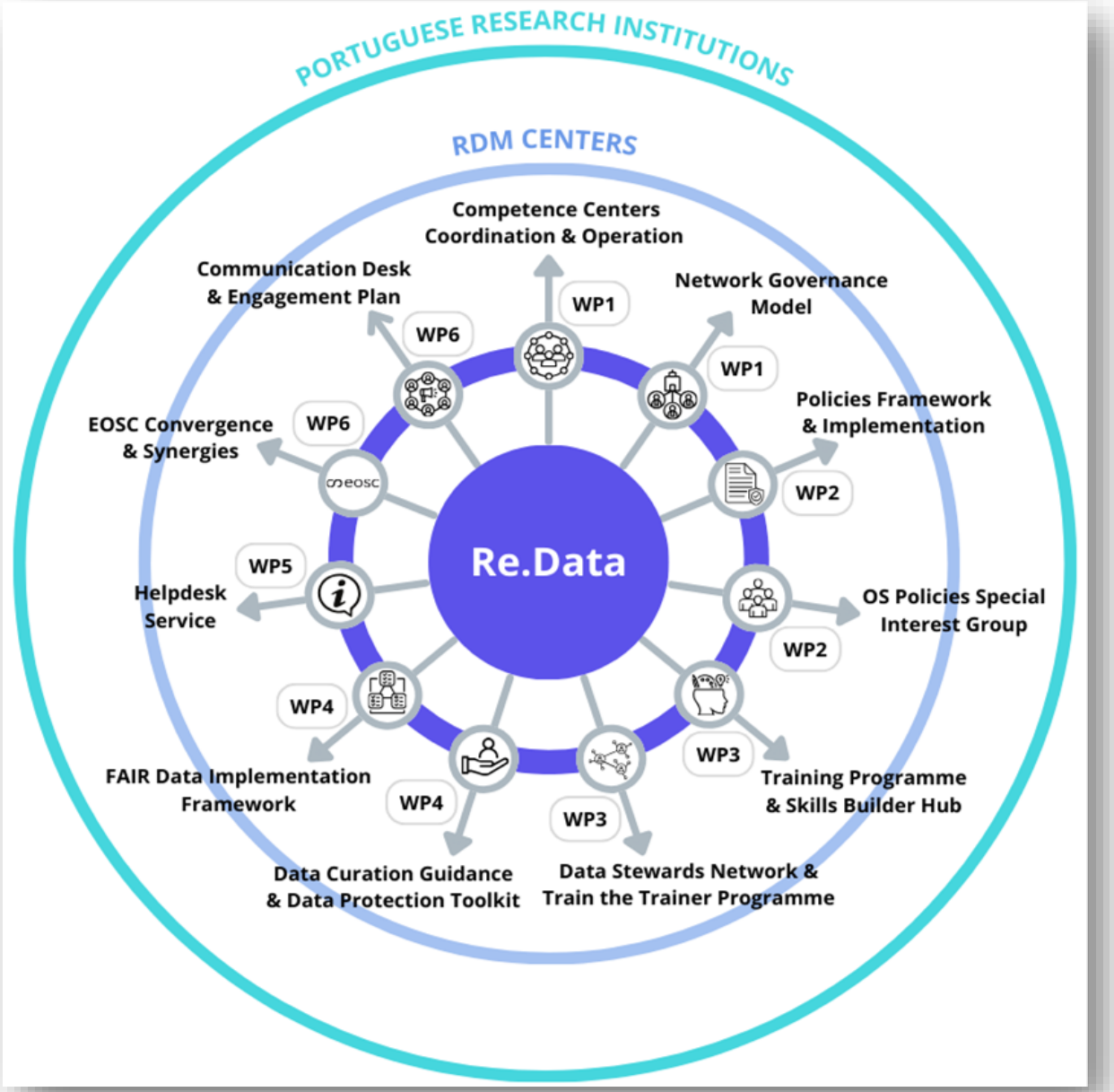
Re.Data

ESTABLISH AND OPERATIONALISE THE PORTUGUESE NETWORK OF RESEARCH DATA MANAGEMENT AND SHARING SUPPORT

1 year Project and national consortium

Universidade do Minho · Universidade de Coimbra · iscte Instituto Universitário de Lisboa · ipb Bragança Polytechnic University / Instituto Politécnico de Bragança · NOVA Universidade Nova de Lisboa · FCCN · fct Fundação para a Ciência e a Tecnologia · PRR Plano de Recuperação e Resiliência · República Portuguesa · Financiado pela União Europeia NextGenerationEU

Development of the Re.Data Network and Training Hub



PARTICIPATORY AND SUSTAINABLE NETWORK

- to attract strategic stakeholders,
- to empower the members of the consortium and the PT research institutions

Training and support actions and programmes as added value aiming FAIR Data Management

POLICIES

R1: Reference Framework and Guidelines for OS and RDM Policies

R2: Resource Toolkit for Policy Implementation

R3: Establishment of National Special Interest Group

TRAINING

R4: Skills Builder Hub

R6: Training roadmap: programme for data curators, repository managers and data stewards

R7: Train-the-trainers programme

R8: Portuguese Data Stewards Network

CURATION

R10: Guidelines for metadata curation in data repositories

R11: Reference catalogue of services and tools

R12: Toolkit on sensitive data and data protection

R13: Guidance to improve the implementation of FAIR data principles

R14: Community Support and Helpdesk Platform

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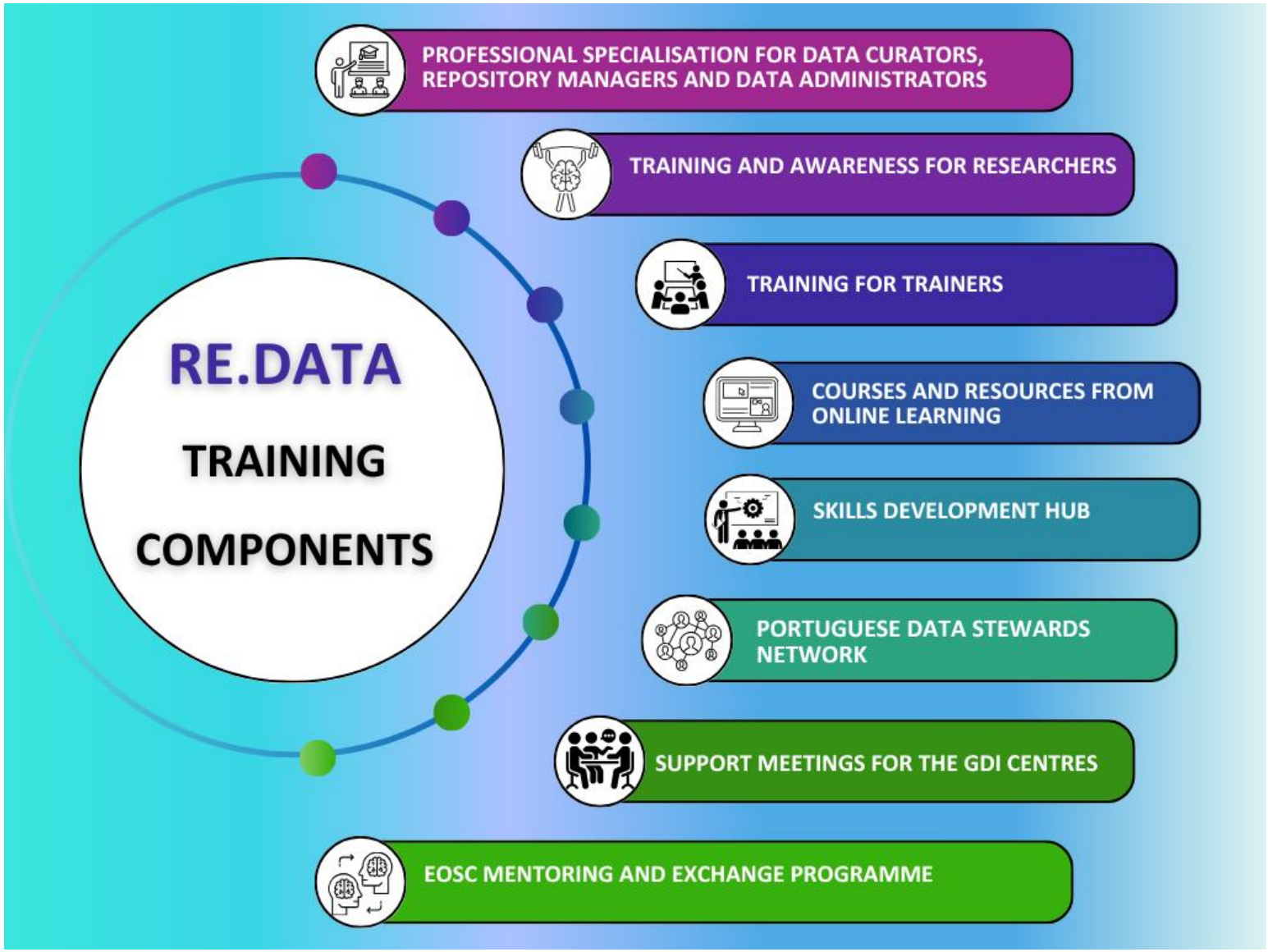
Rede para a Gestão de Dados de Investigação

Re.Data Training Roadmap



https://doi.org/10.5281/zenodo.15224663

Portuguese Data Stewards Network

- The development of the Network began at the RDM Forum.
- It is being formalising and developed under the Re.Data project/consortium.
- Already 70 members registered.
- Main activities to kick-off: **national survey** (who are the professionals supporting RDM), WG on **Data Stewards profiles**.
- Work aligned with EOSC agenda.

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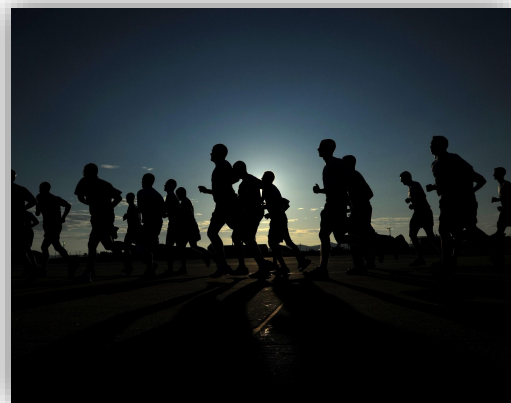
Data are plural, so are data stewards… in PT

- There is a wide diversity of profiles and roles in Portuguese institutions.
- A lot of work is done from libraries and research support offices.
- Many gaps and needs in Portuguese institutions.
- Already good strategies and services being developed in some reference institutions
- But many doubts about the paths to follow...

and delays in the availability of infrastructure and services.



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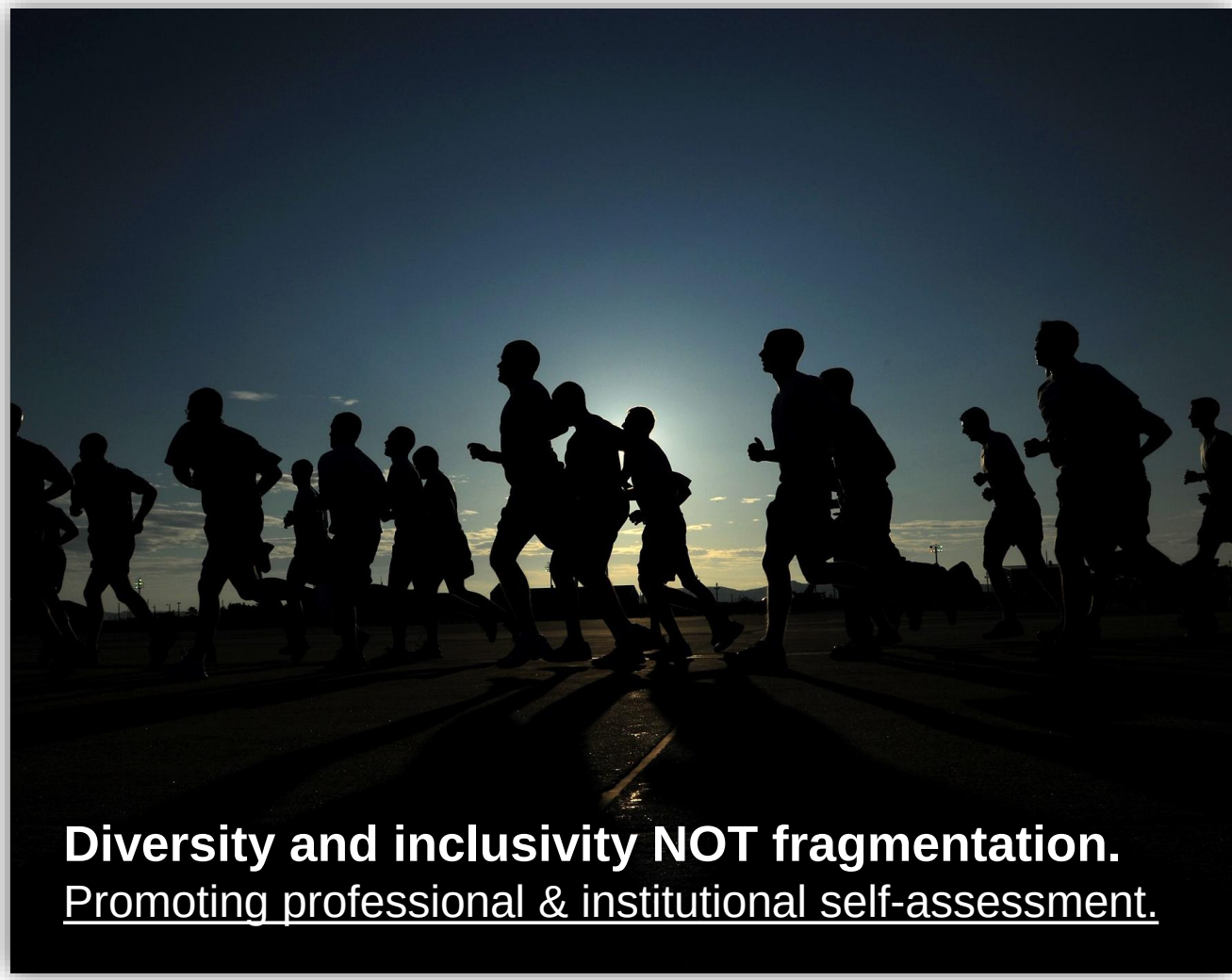
NOVA UNIVERSIDADE NOVA DE LISBOA

Re.Data upskilling route

- A multi-stakeholder and multi-channel approach.
- Aligned with OS/RDM institutional policies.
- Focused on supporting different roles and professional profiles



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Thanks

LinkedIn - https://www.linkedin.com/company/re-data-pt
Bluesky - https://bsky.app/profile/redatapt.bsky.social
YouTube - https://www.youtube.com/@Re.DataPT

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Data are plural, so are data stewards!

Naeem Muhammad
Research Data Manager @ KU Leuven

KU LEUVEN

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Data Stewardship @ KU Leuven

600 years of data
Data stewardship 600 years old? *Where there is data there is data stewardship*
2014 – First RDM Policy, RDM working group
2015 – DMP template – Data stewardship starts
2017 – RDM website
2019 – Establishing RDM Competence Center (RDM-CC)
2021 – FSOB funding for data stewardship – decentralized approach
2022 – Launch of institutional data repository RDR
2025 – 20+ FTE (FOSB + KU Leuven)

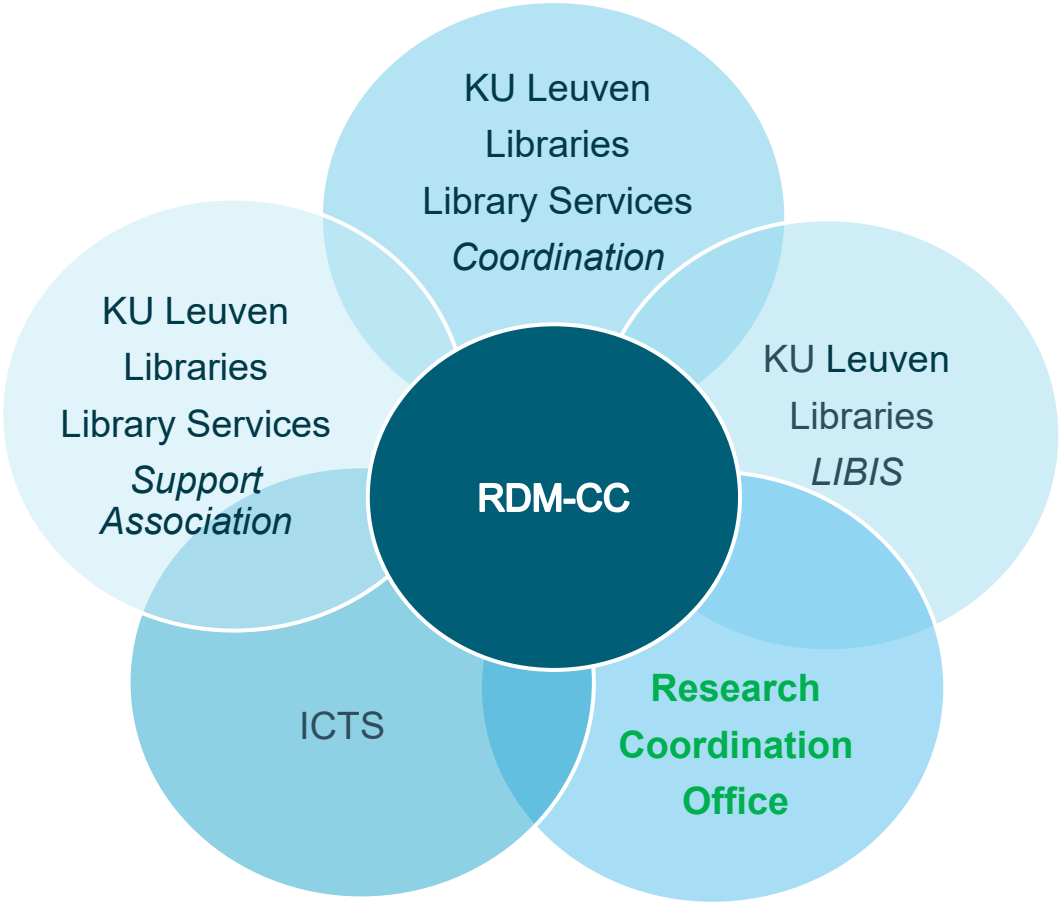
Data Stewardship @ KU Leuven

RDM Steering Committee

RDM Competence Center

RDM Working Groups

- Domain specific RDM teams
  - Biomedical sciences
  - Science and Engineering
  - Social sciences and Humanities
  - ICTS - IT Infrastructure



FRDN Knowledge Hub Community

Network of data stewards and professionals ~ 80 members

Research Data Management (RDM) and Open Science (OS)

Universities and research performing organizations in Flanders, Belgium

Goal: Knowledge exchange and collaboration – learn from each other

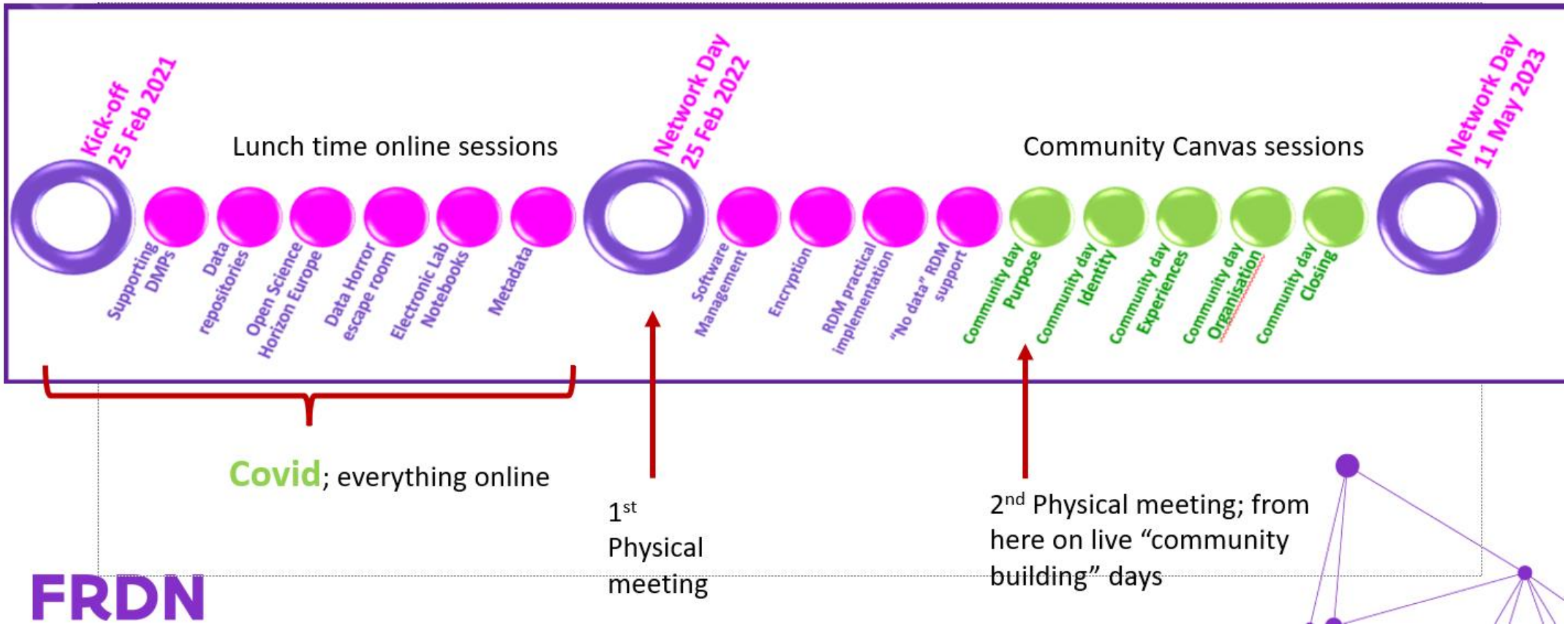
FOSB (Flemish Open Science Board) funded

FOSB focus on 3 areas

- Infrastructure
- **People (data stewards)**
- Policy: governance & funding

KU LEUVEN

FRDN Knowledge Hub Community



Flemish Research Data Network Knowledge Hub History 2021-2023. Zenodo. https://doi.org/10.5281/zenodo.10244263,